

Tertiary Support Program Policy 2025 – University Guidance Framework

The “Tertiary Support Program Policy 2025 – University Guidance Framework” is an extensive listing of Pakistani universities grouped by discipline, field of study and institutional tier. Each table in the framework presents the **university name**, its **city**, the **tier** (from Tier 1 through Tier 4 & below) and whether the institution is **public** or **private**. The framework is intended to help students and advisers identify suitable universities for particular programmes. The following description walks through each discipline and group, highlighting what the tables convey.

Understanding the structure

- **Discipline** – broad area of study such as Engineering, Computer Studies, Health Sciences, Management Sciences, Natural Sciences or Social Sciences & Arts.
- **Group** – specific sub-field within a discipline (e.g., *Aerospace & Aeronautical Engineering, Business Administration & Management, Biological Sciences*).
- **Sector** – indicates whether universities are **public** or **private**.
- **Tiers** – each group categorises universities into Tier 1, Tier 2, Tier 3 and **Tier 4 & Below**. Although the document does not explicitly define the tiers, the ordering suggests Tier 1 universities are highly regarded or better resourced while subsequent tiers represent progressively newer or smaller institutions.

Engineering (Pages 1 – 4)

Aerospace & Aeronautical Engineering (also covers aircraft maintenance, aviation management and avionics)

- **Tier 1 public universities** include established institutions such as the **National University of Sciences & Technology (NUST)** in Islamabad and the **Pakistan Institute of Engineering and Applied Sciences (PIEAS)** in Islamabad, signifying top-ranked programmes. **Air University (AU)** in Islamabad appears in Tier 2, indicating another respected but comparatively smaller programme.
- **Tier 1 private universities** include the **Institute of Space Technology (IST)** in Islamabad and **DHA Suffa University (DSU)** in Karachi.
- Lower tiers list regional institutions such as **NED University of Engineering and Technology (NEDUET)** in Karachi, **Mehran University of Engineering & Technology (MUET)** in Jamshoro, **University of Gujrat (UOG)** in Gujrat and **University of Wah (UoW)** in Wah Cantt.
- Each row in the table pairs a university with its city; the programme names clarifying that these universities offer aviation-related engineering degrees.

Chemical & Petrochemical Engineering (includes petroleum and gas engineering)

- Top public universities include **NUST**, **PIEAS** and **UET Lahore**. Private sector examples in the upper tiers include **Ghulam Ishaq Khan Institute of Engineering Sciences and Technology (GIKI)** in Swabi and **Sir Syed University of Engineering & Technology (SSUET)** in Karachi.
- Lower tiers feature regional campuses such as **University of Chakwal (UoC)** in Chakwal and the **NFC Institute of Engineering & Technology (NFC-IET)** in Multan.

Civil & Environmental Engineering (covers energy systems, geological engineering and water-resource management)

- **UET Lahore**, **NUST** and **PIEAS** dominate Tier 1, reflecting long-standing civil engineering faculties. Other universities such as **Khwaja Fareed University of Engineering & Information Technology (KFUEIT)** in Rahim Yar Khan and **Hazara University** in Mansehra appear in the middle tiers.
- The table line-by-line lists each university and city; the grouping signals where students might pursue civil or environmental engineering.

Industrial & Manufacturing Engineering, Materials/Mining/Textile Engineering and Mechanical Engineering

- Subsequent tables (page 3) list universities for *Industrial and Manufacturing Engineering*, *Materials, Mining & Textile Engineering* and *Mechanical Engineering (Mechatronics and Control)*. Public universities such as **NUST** and **UET Lahore** are prominent, while private institutions like **GIKI** and **SSUET** also feature.
- The document notes that **Computer Engineering** programmes are handled under **Computer Studies**, and **Biotechnology & Biomedical Engineering** appears under **Health Sciences – Other Programmes**.

Marine Engineering

- Marine engineering is treated as its own group; the document lists universities (e.g., **PIEAS**, **UET Lahore** and select naval or maritime institutions) but notes that details are minimal compared with other groups.

Computer Studies (Pages 5 – 12)

Computer Studies comprises several sub-groups: **Computer Science**, **Computer Engineering**, **Information Technology** and **Software Engineering**. For each group the tables provide rows listing universities by sector and tier.

Computer Science (Artificial Intelligence, Business Analytics & Programming, Data Science)

- **Tier 1 public universities** include **NUST**, **COMSATS University Islamabad (CUI)** and **UET Lahore**, indicating strong research-focused computer science programmes.

- **Tier 1 private universities** feature **Lahore University of Management Sciences (LUMS)**, **Ghulam Ishaq Khan Institute (GIKI)**, **Beaconhouse National University (BNU)** and **Habib University (HU)** in Karachi.
- Lower tiers contain a wide range of regional universities such as **University of Mianwali (UMW)** in Mianwali, **University of Wah (UoW)** in Wah Cantt and **University of Gujrat (UOG)** in Gujrat.
- The lines list each university and city; these groups help students find universities offering general computer science and data-science curricula.

Computer Engineering

- The guidance notes that **computer engineering** programmes are listed under Computer Studies rather than Engineering. Tier 1 public institutions include **NUST**, **CUI** and **BUIITEMS (Balochistan University of Information Technology, Engineering & Management Sciences)**.
- Private universities such as **NUCES (FAST)** in Islamabad, **Sir Syed University of Engineering & Technology (SSUET)** in Karachi and **University of Lahore (UOL)** appear across the tiers, providing alternatives to public universities.

Information Technology (Cyber Security, Information Management, Information Security, Business & Information Security)

- **Information Technology** programmes are organised similarly: top public universities include **UET Lahore**, **NUST** and **ITU Lahore**; private tier-1 institutions include **LUMS**, **GIKI** and **Sukkur IBA University**.
- The list continues with regional public universities such as **University of Sargodha (UOS)** and **Hazara University**, and private institutions like **Iqra University**, **MAJU** and **University of Central Punjab (UCP)**, giving prospective students many options.

Software Engineering

- **Software Engineering** appears as a separate group; top public institutions include **UET Lahore**, **COMSATS University** and **NED University**, while private choices encompass **NUCES (FAST)**, **Sir Syed University**, **Habib University** and **Iqra University**.
- Lower tiers list additional universities across Pakistan, ensuring comprehensive coverage for software engineering aspirants.

Health Sciences – MBBS, BDS & BSN (Pages 13 – 14)

This discipline lists medical and dental colleges, along with nursing schools, categorised by tier and sector.

MBBS & BDS programmes

- **Tier 1 public medical schools** include the **Dow University of Health Sciences (DUHS)** in Karachi, **Jinnah Sindh Medical University (JSMU)**, **King Edward Medical University (KEMU)** in Lahore and **Rawalpindi Medical University (RMU)**.
- **Tier 1 private medical colleges** feature **Aga Khan University (AKU)** in Karachi, **Ziauddin University (ZU)** and **Shifa Tameer-e-Millat University (STMU)** in Islamabad.

- The lines continue to list a large number of public and private medical universities across subsequent tiers, such as **Bolan Medical College** in Quetta, **Makran Medical College** in Turbat, **Liaquat University of Medical & Health Sciences (LUMHS)** in Jamshoro and many others. Each line specifies the university and its city, helping applicants identify institutions offering MBBS or BDS programmes.

BSN (Bachelor of Science in Nursing)

- The next table lists nursing colleges and universities. Tier 1 includes public institutions like **KEMU** and **JSMU** and private institutions such as **Aga Khan University** and **Ziauddin University**.
- Lower tiers introduce specialised nursing schools in various cities (e.g., **Government College of Nursing, Khyber Teaching Hospital (KTH)** in Peshawar; **Nursing School Sargodha**; **Abbottabad College of Nursing & Allied Health Sciences**).

Health Sciences – Other Programmes (Pages 15 – 18)

This discipline contains four broad groups: **Clinical & Medical, Allied Health, Pharmaceutical & Nutritional Sciences** and **Vision Care, Diagnostic & Technical/Medical Technology**. There is also a note that **Biotechnology & Biomedical Engineering** is included here rather than under Engineering.

- **Clinical & Medical** programmes include anaesthesia, cardiology, dental hygiene, orthotics and prosthetics, speech and language pathology, and Doctor of Veterinary Medicine. The tables list universities such as **DUHS, KEMU, PUMHSW (Peoples University of Medical & Health Sciences for Women)** in Nawabshah and **SIUT (Sindh Institute of Urology and Transplantation)**. Private institutions include **FMH College of Medicine & Dentistry** in Lahore and **Riphah International University** in Islamabad.
 - **Allied Health** programmes cover physiotherapy, emergency & intensive care sciences, occupational therapy, operation theatre technology, respiratory therapy and critical care sciences. Public universities such as **JSMU, Ayub Medical College** in Abbottabad and **KMU** in Peshawar appear in Tier 1, while private universities like **ZU, RIU, The University of Faisalabad** and **Indus University of Health Sciences** are featured in various tiers.
 - **Pharmaceutical & Nutritional Sciences** include food science, nutrition and pharmacy. Top public universities include **DUHS, KEMU** and **PIMS (Pakistan Institute of Medical Sciences)**; private options encompass **ZU, Jinnah Medical & Dental College (JMDC)** and **LNHMC (Liaquat National Hospital & Medical College)**.
 - **Vision Care, Diagnostic & Technical** programmes cover clinical laboratory sciences, medical imaging technology, nuclear medicine, radiotherapy and related fields. Public institutions such as **NED University, MUET** and **University of Peshawar** are listed, while private institutions include **Salim Habib University** and **SZABIST**.
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Management Sciences (Pages 19 – 23)

Business Administration & Management (business information systems, commerce, digital marketing, management & technology, project management, supply chain management, healthcare management, entrepreneurship)

- **Tier 1 public universities** include **NUST**, **Quaid-i-Azam University (QAU)**, **Institute of Business Administration (IBA)** in Karachi and **University of Punjab (PU)**.
- **Tier 1 private institutions** include **Lahore University of Management Sciences (LUMS)**, **Institute of Business Management (IoBM)** in Karachi, **Shaheed Zulfikar Ali Bhutto Institute of Science & Technology (SZABIST)** and **Greenwich University (GU)**.
- Lower tiers show an extensive list of regional universities and colleges offering business-related degrees, from **Government College University, Faisalabad (GCUF)** to **University of Narowal (UoN)** and **Rawalpindi Women University (RWU)**.

Finance & Economics (Accounting, Finance, Actuarial Science, Banking & Finance, Economics with Data Science, Islamic Banking & Finance, etc.)

- Public tier-1 universities include **NUST**, **QAU** and **Bahauddin Zakariya University (BZU)**.
- Private tier-1 institutions include **LUMS**, **IoBM**, **NUCES (FAST)** and **KSBL (Karachi School of Business & Leadership)**.
- Lower tiers feature regional colleges and professional institutes like **SKANS School of Accountancy**, **Tabani's School of Accountancy (TSA)** and **The Professionals Academy of Commerce (PAC)**, indicating options for chartered accountancy (CA) studies.

Tourism & Hospitality and Chartered Accountancy

- The document also lists universities offering **tourism & hospitality** and **chartered accountancy** programmes. Public options include **University of Peshawar** and **University of Veterinary & Animal Sciences (UVAS)**, while private options include specialised accountancy institutes such as **PAC** and **TSA**.

Natural Sciences (Pages 24 – 26)

Biological Sciences (Bioinformatics, Genetics, Microbiology, Molecular Biology, Zoology, etc.)

- **Tier 1 public universities** include **NUST**, **University of Karachi (UoK)**, **University of Sargodha (UOS)** and **Quaid-e-Azam University**.
- **Tier 1 private institutions** include **LUMS**, **University of Lahore (UOL)** and **Lasbela University of Agriculture, Water & Marine Sciences (LUAWMS)**.
- Subsequent tiers list universities such as **University of Peshawar (UOP)**, **Hazara University**, **University of Education (UE) Lahore** and **Kinnaird College for Women**, providing many options across Pakistan.

Chemistry, Physics & Marine Science (includes biochemistry and forensic chemistry)

- Public institutions like **NUST**, **AWKUM (Abdul Wali Khan University Mardan)** and **UAF (University of Agriculture Faisalabad)** occupy upper tiers. Private options include **LUMS**, **UOL** and **Northern University**. The listing emphasises the availability of pure and applied science programmes across the country.

Statistics & Mathematics (Applied Mathematics)

- Tier 1 public universities include **NUST**, **UET Lahore**, **University of Punjab** and **University of Peshawar**. Private institutions such as **LUMS**, **UOL** and **NUCES (FAST)** also offer strong statistics and mathematics programmes. Lower tiers list regional colleges and universities, enabling students from various regions to pursue quantitative disciplines.

Social Sciences & Arts (Pages 27 – 33)

This broad discipline spans **Architecture**, **Art & Design**, **Education**, **Fashion & Textiles**, **Health & Physical Education**, **Islamic & Comparative Religions Studies**, **Language & Literature**, and **Law & Criminal Studies**. Each group presents rows of universities with their cities.

Architecture

- **National College of Arts (NCA)** in Lahore, **NUST** (Islamabad) and **NEDUET** (Karachi) lead the public tier 1 list. Private tier-1 institutions include **Indus Valley School of Art & Architecture (IVS)** in Karachi and **Beaconhouse National University (BNU)** in Lahore.
- Lower tiers include **Government College University, Faisalabad (GCUF)** and regional colleges like **Government Post Graduate College** in smaller cities.

Art & Design

- This group covers programmes such as fine arts, interior design, product design and jewellery design. Key public institutions in the top tier are **NCA**, **LCWU (Lahore College for Women University)** and **University of Karachi (UoK)**.
- Private institutions like **PIFD (Pakistan Institute of Fashion & Design)**, **BNU**, **IVS** and **Textile Institute of Pakistan (TIP)** dominate the private tiers, highlighting specialised options for design students.

Education (Education & Research, Special Education)

- Public tier-1 universities include **UoK**, **UoP (University of Peshawar)** and **University of Education (UE) Lahore**, while private tier-1 institutions encompass **AKU**, **Jinnah University for Women** and **Notre Dame Institute of Education**.
- Lower tiers list teacher-training colleges and regional universities, illustrating the wide availability of education programmes across Pakistan.

Fashion & Textiles

- Public institutions such as **PIFD** and **National College of Arts** offer top-tier fashion design programmes.
- Private schools like **TIP**, **BNU**, **Indus University** and **Iqra University** provide alternatives for fashion, textile management and merchandising.

Health & Physical Education

- The tables list universities (public and private) that offer sports sciences, kinesiology and related programmes. Public examples include **UoK** and **UoS**, while private entries feature **Habib University** and **Jinnah University for Women**.

Islamic & Comparative Religions Studies

- Public universities such as **UoK**, **UoP**, **UoS** and **IIUI (International Islamic University Islamabad)** lead this group, providing programmes in Islamic studies and comparative religion.
- Private institutions include **Iqra University** and **Greenwich University**. Each line pairs the university with its city, guiding students interested in religious studies.

Language & Literature (Applied Linguistics, English, Urdu, Pashto, Sindhi, Arabic)

- The framework lists numerous public universities across all tiers, including **UoK**, **PU**, **UoP**, **FJWU** and **UoS**.
- Private institutions like **UCP**, **LUMS**, **SZABIST**, **Greenwich University** and **University of Lahore** also offer language and literature programmes.

Law & Criminal Studies (Criminology)

- Leading public law schools include **UoK**, **PU**, **UoP** and **IUB**.
- Private options include **LUMS**, **UOL**, **UMT** and specialised law colleges such as **SZABUL** in Karachi. Lower tiers list regional law colleges across Pakistan, ensuring coverage for legal education.

How to use the guidance

Each line in the document provides the **university name** and **city**, organised under a specific **group**, **sector** and **tier**. To interpret a row:

1. **Identify the discipline and group** at the top of the table (e.g., Engineering → Aerospace & Aeronautical Engineering).
2. **Note the sector** – whether the institution is public or private.
3. **Look across the four tiers**; universities in the left-most column (Tier 1) are generally the most established, while those in later columns represent newer or regional options.
4. **Read each line** to see the university name and its city; this helps determine proximity and whether the university fits your field of interest.

The guidance framework is comprehensive, listing universities from large metropolitan areas to smaller towns. Prospective students should consider the **tier, location, programme quality** and **public/private status** when using the document to make educational decisions.
